

# Ethernet and the Link Layer

Computer Networks - Computer Science

## 1. Overview

This session introduces ethernet and the link layer within Computer Networks. It sets out the definitions used, the situations in which the material applies, and how it connects to the surrounding weeks of the module.

## 2. Key ideas

The central ideas of ethernet and the link layer are developed from first principles and then applied to worked examples. Emphasis is placed on the conditions under which each result holds, since applying a result outside its hypotheses is the most frequent source of error.

## 3. In practice

Exercises for this week apply ethernet and the link layer to problems of the kind met in assessment. Working them alongside the notes, rather than afterwards, is the intended use of this material.